provide them with. We should have a system of collecting, recording and documenting the history of our party across the country.'[94]

Training: Notes from Rambhau Mhalgi Prabodhini

In September 2019, I spent a couple of very fruitful days researching this book at the Rambhau Mhalgi Prabodhini—a unique training and research academy, registered as a charitable trust—nestled in the Western Ghats in Thane, on the outskirts of Mumbai. Spread over 15 acres of a leafy hillside, the picturesque institute runs training modules for corporations and individuals on leadership. It also provides political training to BJP politicians.

Training is a crucial part of the party's organisational restructuring and Prabodhini fulfils a vital purpose in that deeper ecosystem. Its state-of-the-art facilities and infrastructure are, by my reckoning, on par with India's best B-schools. Apart from its educational and social sector work—it has official affiliations with the United Nations' ECOSOC, University of Mumbai and the National Skills Development Corporation—Prabodhini holds ten or twelve events a year on its own for training practising politicians (from gram panchayat leaders to parliamentarians) as well as offering certificate courses in leadership for those wishing to work in public life. 'These events are open for all political parties,' said Sahasrabuddhe, who is also vice chairman of the academy. 'So, if anyone from any other political party wants to attend, they are welcome to do so.'[95] When asked what kinds of themes make up the courses, another functionary mentioned topics like media management. 'We have developed many courses. These include training on things like "bhashan kala"—how to give speeches and ideas on Hindutva.'[96]

Separately, Prabodhini also hosts twelve or thirteen events on average each year that are organised by the BJP. In the year that I was there, for instance, it had hosted party training sessions for BJP MLAs from Arunachal Pradesh as well as for state legislators who had defected to the BJP from Maharashtra's Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) from the Pimpri Chinchwad areas and other constituencies. 'They want to know about the party,' said one executive involved in the training. 'They don't want to know who is